



simulation, deep-sea projects and radioactive areas where humans cannot go. They are suited for 3D-gaming too, because they can add that extra depth to the game and make it look more realistic and playable.

These monitors have yet to make an impact in the local market because of the high price and complexity of the technology. But we can hope they will become affordable in future.

Easy on the eye

For anyone who spends more than couple of hours a day in front of a computer, eye strain is an important consideration. There are several factors that impact the eye-friendliness of a monitor.

Resolution: This refers to the sharpness and clarity of an image. For monitors the screen resolution is expressed as number of dots (pixels) on the entire screen. This means that a 640 x 480 pixel (or VGA) screen is capable



of displaying 640 distinct dots on each of 480 lines, which is about 3,00,000 pixels.

Refresh Rate: This is the rate at which each pixel is redrawn on a screen. If you view an image at lower refresh rates (say, 60 Hz), the images will flicker, causing eye-strain. The ideal setting for flicker-free viewing about 85 Hz, but 75 Hz is comfortable too. Make sure that your monitor supports a refresh rate of at least 75 Hz. If you have a powerful graphics card that can generate images at high-resolutions and refresh rates, make sure that your monitor is able to support them.

Radiation: Long hours spent in front of a monitor can cause severe headaches, and even permanent damage to the eyes. While modern CRT displays abide by the new, and stricter emission standards, it would still be advisable to use anti-glare screens to eliminate electromagnetic radiation (EMR) from the display.

Workshop: Setting Up Dual Monitors

The introduction of the graphical user interface (GUI) has made it a pleasure to work on the PC. But with more applica-

tions and more windows to work with, the strain on one's fingers has increased. This can be reduced through a smart option—dual monitors.



Working with dual monitors is always more productive because you can get your work done faster with having to switch within windows. The market is flooded with dual-monitor cards and their prices are falling fast. Big players like ATI, nVidia and Matrox have deluged the market with different variants of such cards.

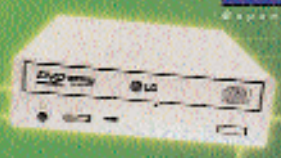
Another interesting thing is that manufacturers aren't just providing a dual-monitor-ready card, they're also making their cards feature-rich by providing TV-tuner compatibility. Now you can watch your favourite program on one monitor while you surf the net on another! These cards are also very simple to install and



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